

Traffic incident operations dashboard

Greybox only — no colour, no type styling. Everything in this document is judged against two clocks: **time to awareness** (event created → operator notices) and **time to decision** (notices → dispatch or dismiss).

TARGET · TIME TO AWARENESS	TARGET · TIME TO DECISION, CRITICAL	OPERATOR
≤ 2 s	≤ 15 s	12-hour shift · dim room · 1440px+ · keyboard-first · hundreds of events

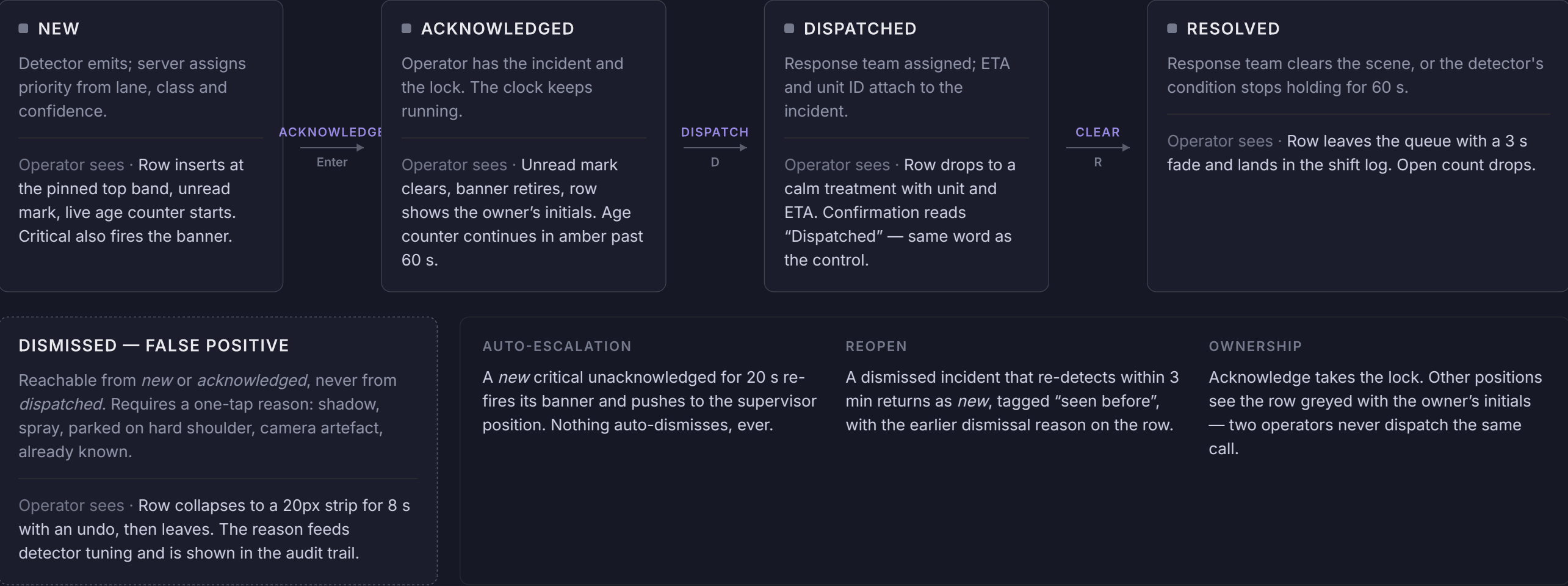
CONTENTS		STATUS
01 Journey map	04 Three layouts considered	Pass A of three. Greybox by intention — colour, type and motion
02 Incident state diagram	+ recommendation	are decided in Pass B.
03 Wireframes, frames 1–3		

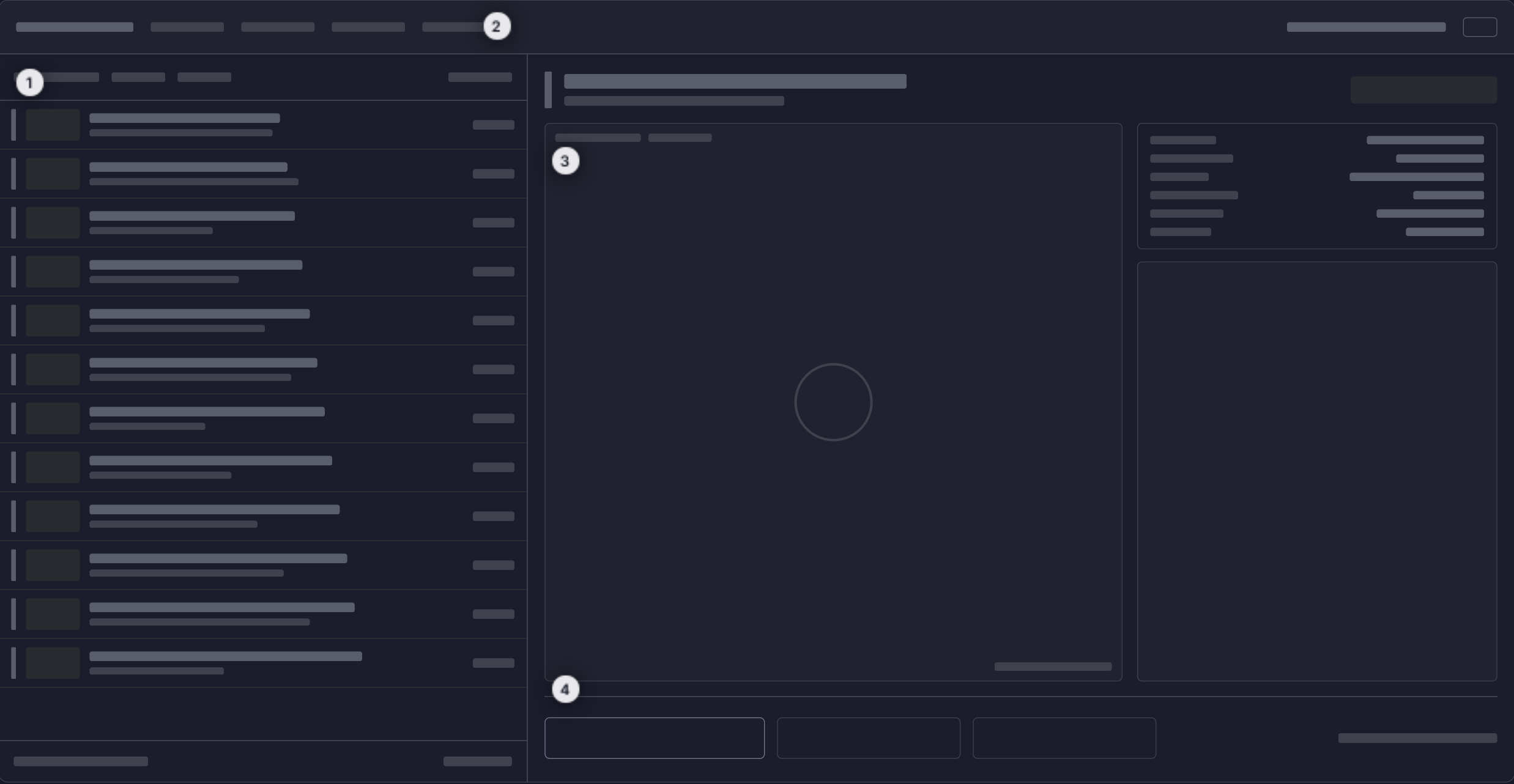
Journey map — one critical event, detection to dispatch

00 · DETECTION Detector fires on the camera feed	01 · ARRIVAL Event reaches the operator position	02 · NOTICE Something changed, and it matters	03 · ORIENT What, where, how bad, how sure	04 · VERIFY Read the snapshot against the claim	05 · DECIDE Dispatch, or dismiss with a reason	06 · HAND OFF Response team notified and acknowledged
STATE Operator is elsewhere — reviewing a debris call two junctions south.	STATE Peripheral. Head down on another incident.	STATE Startle, then annoyance if this is the fourth false positive this hour.	STATE Working memory loaded. Actively suppressing the previous task.	STATE Sceptical — the operator is checking the machine, correctly.	STATE Committed, but exposed — this call is attributable to them.	STATE Relief, then immediate return to the queue.
FAILURE MODE Model latency and clip buffering add dead time nobody sees.	FAILURE MODE Event appends to the bottom of a scrolled list and is never seen.	FAILURE MODE Alert fatigue. Mediums and criticals announce themselves the same way.	FAILURE MODE Facts scattered across the pane, so the eye hunts instead of lands.	FAILURE MODE Snapshot too small, or too old to match what the label says.	FAILURE MODE Ambiguous button naming; hesitation over an irreversible-feeling action.	FAILURE MODE No confirmation, so the operator re-checks and loses the thread.
4 s	30 s	12 s	20 s	15 s	10 s	5 s

Seconds lost at this step, worst realistic case

Total worst case, detection → dispatch: **96 s**. Of that, **62 s** sits in noticing and orienting — the two steps the design owns outright.



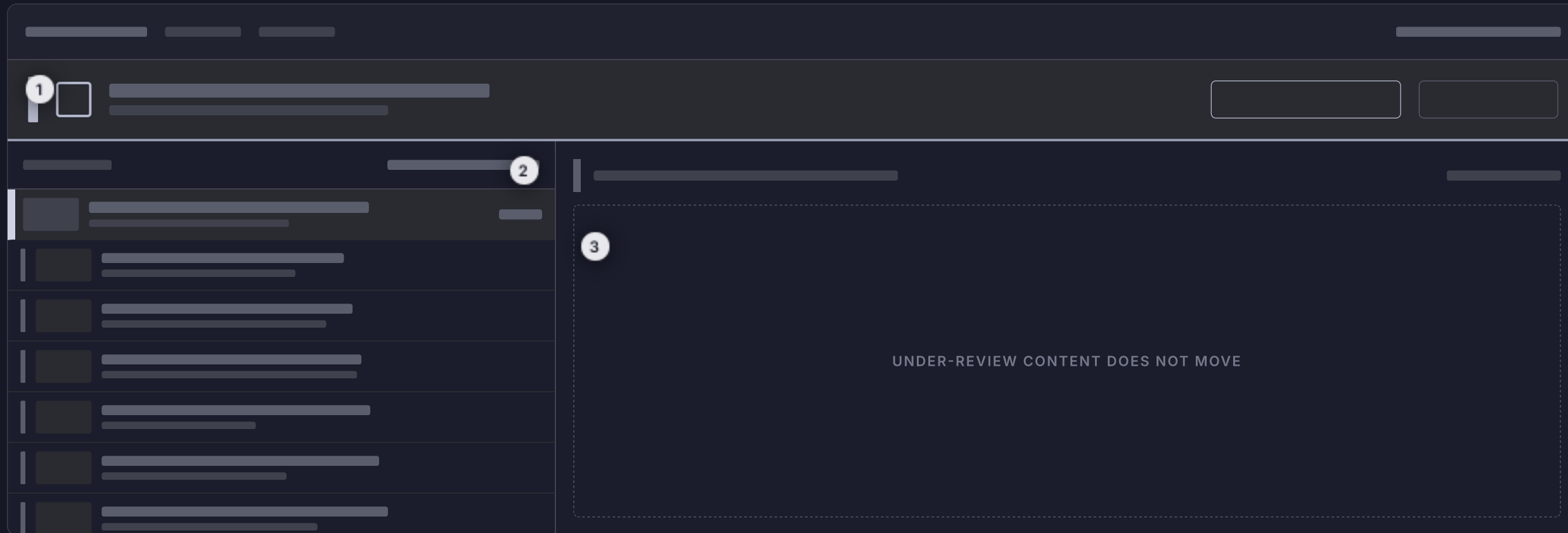


1 Sta
44
Fee
hea
ope
cou
pri
UT
loc
mu
Gla
nev
rea
pat

2 Pin
crit
ba
Zer
wh
not
crit
one
crit
eve
app

3 Tri
que
43
Tw
rov
40
vis
144
wit
scr
Pri
stri
thu
wh
wh
age

4 De
—
slo
—



1

Ban

64

Ent

tak

spa

the

not

cov

con

Can

cla

loc

lan

the

act

2

Ro

ins

—

app

in t

pin

ban

alre

full

hei

the

bel

slic

sel

rov

not

3

Pro

rea

are

The

par

kee

sel

and

scr

arr

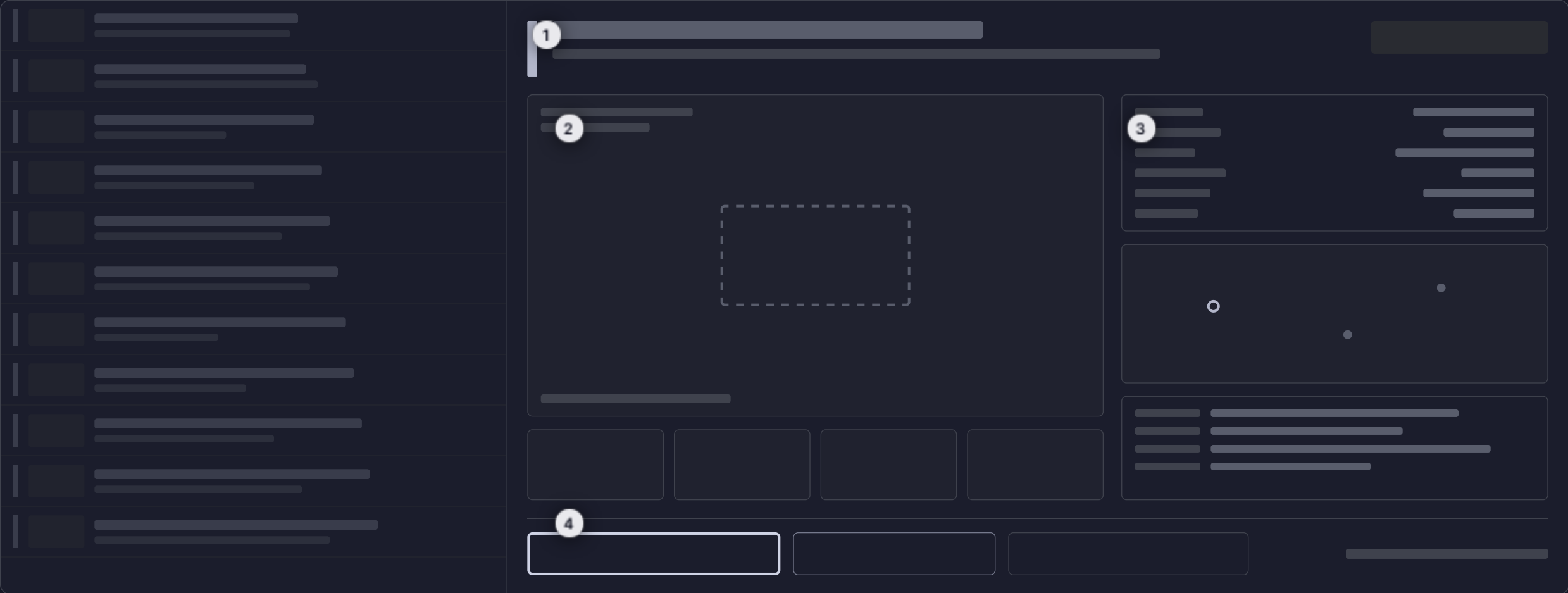
crit

nev

ste

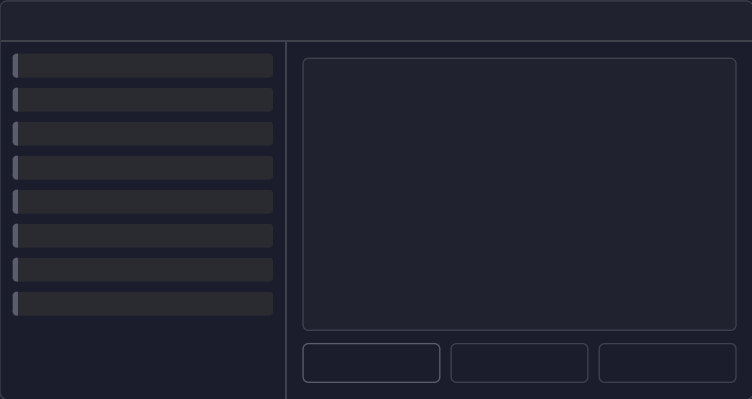
foo

ear



- 1 **Pri**
its
No
"cr
"liv
of
app
The
is t
arg
the
- 2 **Sn**
Bu
can
and
tim
det
box
stri
fra
sid
trig
- 3 **Fa**
ma
Loc
mil
det
scr
late
con
pla
des
nea
can
bel
- 4 **De**
—
ack
onl
wit
Au
sits
abo
rec
vis

A Master–detail split



For · One list, one truth, one keyboard axis: ↑↓ to move, Enter to open, D to dispatch. Cheapest possible time to decision.

Against · A flat list buries a critical under twenty mediums unless sorting is aggressive — and aggressive sorting reorders under the operator's cursor.

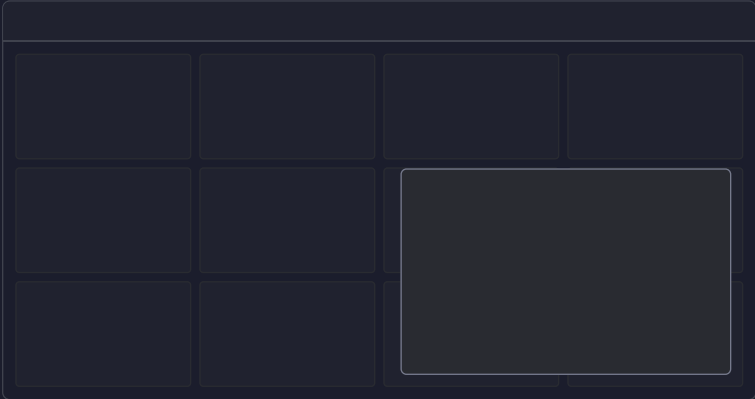
B Priority-lane board



For · Priority is spatial — a critical always appears in the same column, so awareness is a glance at one region, not a scan.

Against · Four lanes of mostly-empty columns waste the density budget, and the critical lane sits idle for hours — the operator stops looking at it. No single keyboard axis.

C Video wall plus overlay



For · Keeps the camera imagery primary, which is what operators say they trust; the overlay lands on top of the feed the event came from.

Against · Twelve moving tiles is a permanent motion field — the one thing that destroys the salience of a new alert. Overlays also cover the evidence underneath them.

RECOMMENDATION

A, with one lane borrowed from B

Time to awareness. Master–detail alone relies on the operator watching the list. So the queue keeps one pinned region at its top — a critical band that is empty and 0px tall almost always, and expands with a banner when a critical lands. That is lane B's spatial guarantee at a tenth of its cost: one fixed place where criticals appear, no permanent dead columns. Everything else stays a single time-ordered list. Measured target: notice within 2 s of arrival without a mouse move.

Time to decision. One list means one keyboard axis and no mode: ↑↓ moves and previews, Enter acknowledges and takes the lock, D dispatches, X dismisses with a reason. The detail pane's slot layout never changes between incident types, so the four facts that drive the call sit in the same four pixels every time — the operator reads position, not labels. Rejecting C is the strongest choice here: a live tile wall costs awareness permanently in exchange for trust the snapshot already provides.